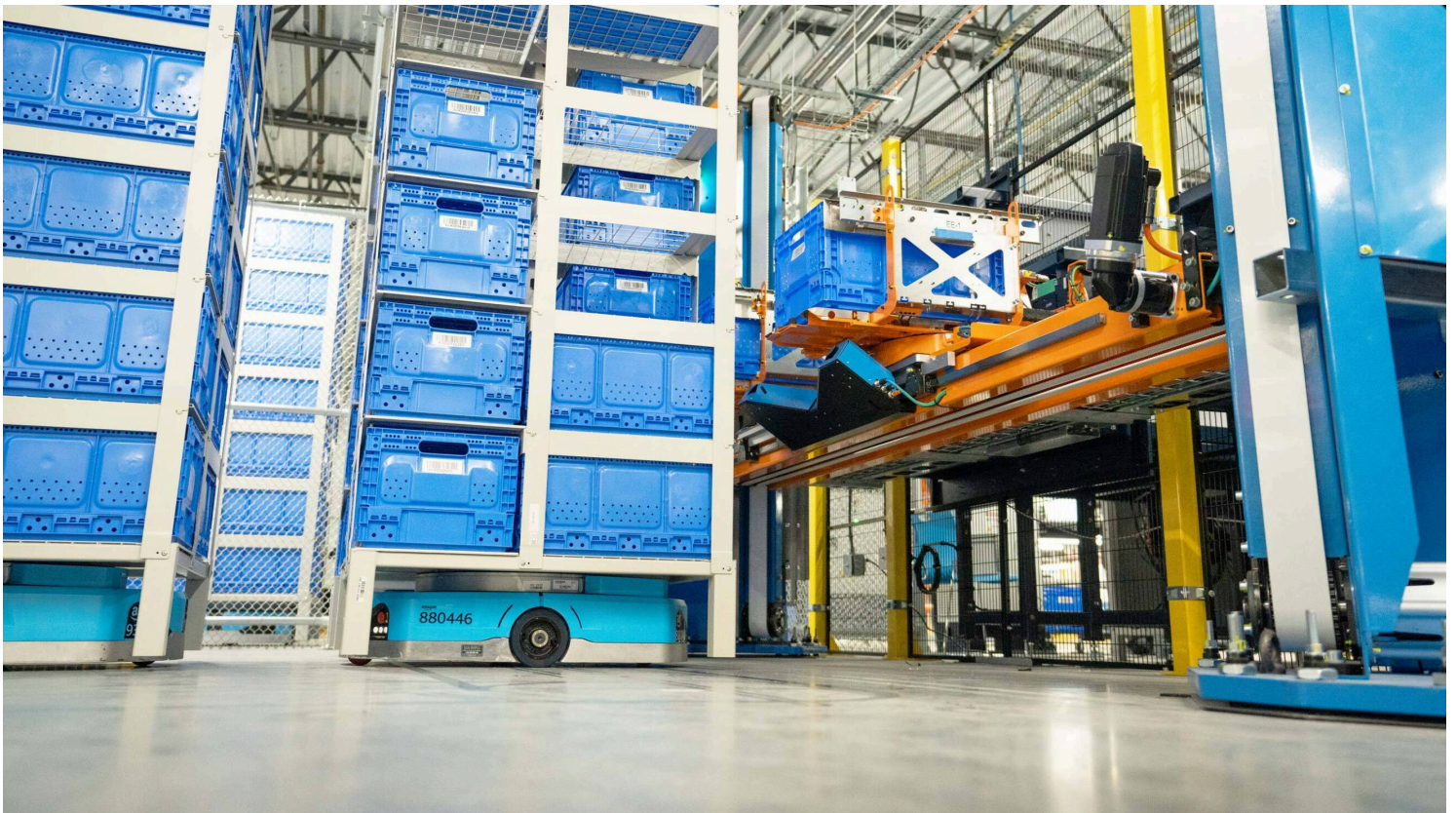


News / Operations

Amazon announces 2 new ways it's using robots to assist employees and deliver for customers

The new robotic solutions, Sequoia and Digit, will support workplace safety and help Amazon deliver to customers faster.



Written by **Scott Dresser**, VP, Amazon Robotics

October 18, 2023

3 min read

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



From our latest robotic arms like [Sparrow](#) and [Cardinal](#), to our first autonomous mobile robot, [Proteus](#), we're excited to see the impact our technology is having in Amazon's operations. We now have over 750,000 robots working collaboratively with our employees, taking on highly repetitive tasks and freeing employees up to better deliver for our customers.

With all of these efforts underway, it makes us particularly proud to share that we have just launched a new robotic system in time to help fulfill customer orders for holiday shopping this year. Sequoia is the name of this new technology, and it's now operating at one of our fulfillment centers in Houston, Texas.



To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



fulfillment centers up to 75% faster than we can today. This means we can list items for sale on Amazon.com more quickly, benefiting both sellers and customers. When orders are placed, Sequoia also reduces the time it takes to process an order through a fulfillment center by up to 25%, which improves our shipping predictability and increases the number of goods we can offer for Same-Day or Next-Day shipping.



Building off a series of research and development efforts, Sequoia integrates multiple robot systems to containerize our inventory into totes, bringing together mobile robots, gantry systems, robotic arms, and a new ergonomic employee workstation. The system works by having mobile robots transport containerized inventory directly to a gantry, a tall frame with a platform supporting equipment that can either restock totes or send them to an employee to pick out inventory that customers have ordered.

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



supporting our efforts to reduce the risk of injuries.



Once customer orders picked from inventory are retrieved, the remaining inventory needs to be consolidated so that our totes are full, and we are efficiently managing site storage. This is where our newest robotic arm, Sparrow, comes in, taking on the highly repetitive task of consolidating inventory in totes so that full totes can be returned to storage.



How Amazon is working to close the skills gap and train employees for jobs of the future

Recognizing the people and skills behind Amazon's technical roles on National Skilled Trades Day.

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



operations employees about now we can use automation to make our workplace better. This collaboration is driving meaningful impact: Company data shows that, in 2022, recordable incident rates and lost-time incident rates were 15% and 18% lower, respectively, at Amazon Robotics sites than non-robotics sites. Sequoia will help continue this positive trend.



In addition to Sequoia, Amazon Robotics continues to invest in and try novel approaches to automation. That's why we also have begun testing mobile manipulator solutions at our robotics research and development site just south of Seattle. These are mobile robots that can move while also grasping and handling items.

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



Broadening our partnership with Agility Robotics, we will begin testing their bipedal robot, Digit, for use in our operations. Agility is one of the companies Amazon invested in as part of the [Amazon Industrial Innovation Fund](#). Digit can move, grasp, and handle items in spaces and corners of warehouses in novel ways. Its size and shape are well suited for buildings that are designed for humans, and we believe that there is a big opportunity to scale a mobile manipulator solution, such as Digit, which can work collaboratively with employees. Our initial use for this technology will be to help employees with tote recycling, a highly repetitive process of picking up and moving empty totes once inventory has been completely picked out of them.

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



Ensuring robotics are collaborative and support employees is central to how we design or deploy systems like Sequoia and Digit. Over the last 10 years, we've rolled out hundreds of thousands of robotics systems while also creating hundreds of thousands of new jobs within our operations. This includes 700 categories of new job types, in skilled roles, which didn't exist within the company beforehand. By equipping our employees with new technology and training them to develop new skills, we're creating career paths and new and exciting ways for people to contribute here at Amazon.

Sign up for the weekly Amazon newsletter

Enter email



[Amazon Privacy Policy](#) Opt out anytime

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



前往平台观看：

From the hardware to the artificial intelligence embedded in our robotics, we are passionate about technology that makes the work experience of our employees safer, easier, and less repetitive. Doing so gives our employees the time and opportunity to take a step back, look at how orders are moving through our sites, and find new ways to delight and serve our customers.

Learn more about [how robots help Amazon employees deliver for customers](#).

Trending news and stories

- Amazon Prime Air drone delivery is expanding to nearly 500 US cities and towns this year
 - AWS commits more than \$500 million to student cloud and AI training
 - 'Sterling Point' Season 2: Everything to know and how to watch Season 1 on Prime Video
 - OpenAI Daybreak models now available to eligible customers on Amazon Bedrock
-

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



More Amazon News



1 / 4



Amazon continues to help employees and delivery drivers stay safe this summer

June 25, 2026

Operations



A behind-the-scenes look at how Amazon prepares for its biggest shopping events of the year

June 23, 2026

Operations

Amazon News

Press Center

To sign up for news alerts from Amazon, click [here](#) and choose "Allow" for notifications.

Amazon News



Country & Language:



Careers 

Site Map

More from Amazon



[Amazon.com](#) | [Conditions of Use](#) | [Amazon Privacy Policy](#) | © 1996-2026 Amazon.com, Inc. or its affiliates